OAVS TGT · Current Affairs

International Affairs & Defence

Built from the international and defence questions in your 5 previous-year papers

Coverage window: Jan 2025 – 28 Oct 2026

How this part is organised

International affairs and defence were **27 of 150** current-affairs questions (18%, or 4–8 per paper), tied with science as the largest topic. They split into defence exercises (5), defence bodies, orders and operations (6), India's bilateral visits, treaties and MoUs (6), geopolitics and world events (5), and reports, indices and international days (5).

Section	Topic	Why it matters
1	The world in Oct 2026: wars and crises	NATO, Black Sea deal, Mueller report, US election were all asked
2	India's foreign relations and treaties	Bhutan visit, ECTA, climate agenda, Nepal border, Haryana–Dubai MoU
3	Summits and organisations, 2026–27	Venue and date questions are easy marks
4	Defence: operations, exercises, budget, purchases	5 exercise questions in your PYQs
5	Reports and indices	SDG report, ILO report, population report
6	Practice MCQs (25) and answer key	—

Reliability key. ✔ = checked against live web sources on 28 Oct 2026. ◆ = from my own knowledge, so cross-check once before the exam. **War and diplomacy news changes daily**, so treat Section 1 as a snapshot of late Oct 2026.

What the PYQs tell us

Paper	Q	Topic asked	Type
Sci 2024	41	Country that called India and China 'Friendly Sovereign Global Centres of Power' (Mar 2023) – Russia	Diplomacy
Sci 2024	50	Shekatkar Committee (defence expenditure rebalancing, chairman Lt Gen D. B. Shekatkar)	Defence
Sci 2024	54	NATO's 32nd member (Mar 2024) – Sweden	Geopolitics
Sci 2024	56	IND-INDO CORPAT – navies of India and Indonesia	Exercise
Sci 2024	60	US Republican candidate for the 2024 election – Donald Trump	Geopolitics
Sci 2024	63	'Nipun' mines – developed by ARDE	Defence
Maths 2024	44	SDG Report 2022 – India ranked 121 of 163	Report
Maths 2024	48	International Year of Millets 2023 opening in Rome – by FAO	Intl organisation
Maths 2024	51	Black Sea grain deal (Nov 2022) – Russia and Ukraine	Geopolitics
Maths 2024	59	Exercise Pitch Black 2022 – organised by Australia	Exercise
Maths 2024	64	India–Australia ECTA – came into force 29 Dec 2022	Treaty
Maths 2024	66	ILO World Social Protection Report – 47% had at least one benefit	Report
Maths 2024	68	Garuda-VII (Oct–Nov 2022, Jodhpur) – India and France air forces	Exercise
Maths 2024	69	Operation Megh Chakra – CBI drive against child abuse material	Operation
Eng 2019	1	Dec 2018 visit to India – Prime Minister of Bhutan	Visit
Eng 2019	6	President Kovind received Croatia's highest civilian award (Mar 2019)	Visit
Eng 2019	9	State of World Population 2019 – smallest population Vatican City	Report
Eng 2019	25	Mueller Report – 2016 US presidential election	Geopolitics
Eng 2022	4	SAMPRITI-IX – India–Bangladesh joint army exercise (Meghalaya)	Exercise
Eng 2022	10	Nepal's panel on 11 houses allegedly built by China in Humla	Geopolitics
Eng 2022	11	UHC Day 2021 theme – 'Leave No One's Health Behind'	International day
Eng 2022	15	Operation Sadbhawana – Indian Army in Jammu and Kashmir	Operation
Eng 2022	30	US–India Climate and Clean Energy Agenda 2030 Partnership (Apr 2021)	Treaty
SS 2023	3	BEL signed an MoU with ADA for the AMCA programme (Feb 2023)	Defence
SS 2023	9	DUSTLIK – 4th joint exercise of India and Uzbekistan	Exercise
SS 2023	10	Indian Army MoU with 11 banks for Agniveers (Oct 2022)	Defence
SS 2023	12	Haryana MoU with the Government of Dubai (Oct 2022)	MoU

Patterns to exploit

- **Exercises are the most predictable.** Each question gives an exercise name and asks the country, service or place. Learn the table in Section 4.
- **Geopolitics questions follow the news of the previous year** (NATO expansion, Black Sea grain deal, US election). For your exam, that means the 2026 Iran war, Russia–Ukraine talks and the US midterms.
- **India's bilateral links** (visits, MoUs, treaties) are asked by country: Section 2 lists the latest by partner.
- **Reports and indices** need the rank or number: Section 5.
- **Defence organisations and operations** are asked by purpose (who developed it, which force ran it).

1. The world in Oct 2026: wars and crises

Topic	Facts	Chk
US–Israel war with Iran	Began in **late Feb 2026** when the US and Israel attacked Iran, killing Supreme Leader **Ali Khamenei**; **Mojtaba Khamenei** is now Supreme Leader. It followed the 12-day war of June 2025. A **Pakistan-mediated ceasefire** (April) and an **Islamabad Memorandum** (June) paused large-scale fighting, but the deal collapsed on **8 July** after Iran attacked ships in the **Strait of Hormuz**. In October, tanker strikes surged (over two dozen ships hit); talks continue through Saudi, Turkish and Pakistani officials	✔
Effect on India	Oil and gas supply shocks: the RBI cited 'crude price shocks' when it raised rates on 7 Oct (see Finance part); in May 2026 PM Modi urged citizens to follow austerity steps amid fuel shortages	✔
Lebanon and Gaza	Israel–Hezbollah war resumed on 2 Mar 2026 with a fragile ceasefire since 16 Apr; Gaza ceasefire of **Oct 2025** continues unevenly under a US-designed **Board of Peace**, with **Nickolay Mladenov** overseeing it	✔
Russia–Ukraine	War continues. On 12 Oct the US announced an 'energy ceasefire' that was violated within a day; on 21 Oct US envoy Steve Witkoff met Putin in St Petersburg, and Moscow agreed to resume US-mediated **trilateral talks after 10 Nov**. A localised truce at Oleshky was announced on 23 Oct (single-source reports)	✔
United States	President Donald Trump. **US midterm elections on 3 Nov 2026**. The US withdrew its separate 25% tariff on India in Feb 2026 (see Finance part)	✔
Your PYQ links	The Black Sea grain deal (Nov 2022) was Russia–Ukraine, brokered by Turkey and the UN. Sweden became NATO's 32nd member in Mar 2024; NATO Secretary-General is **Mark Rutte**. The Mueller Report (2019) concerned Russian interference in the 2016 US election	◆

Source note: the Iran-war details come from the Council on Foreign Relations tracker, Crisis Group and Wikipedia-level summaries; some day-by-day claims come from newsletters. Confirm any detail you plan to memorise.

2. India's foreign relations and treaties

Topic	Facts	Chk
Pahalgam attack and Operation Sindoor	**22 Apr 2025:** Pahalgam terror attack killed 26 civilians. On 23 Apr the Cabinet Committee on Security put the **Indus Waters Treaty (1960) in abeyance**. **Operation Sindoor** began on the night of 6–7 May 2025: precision strikes on 9 terror sites in Pakistan and PoK, an 88-hour tri-service campaign. Pakistan retaliated ('Bunyan-um-Marsoos', 10 May) and a ceasefire followed on 10 May 2025. First anniversary marked on 7 May 2026	✔
Indus Waters Treaty	Still in abeyance (MEA, May–June 2026), until Pakistan 'credibly and irrevocably' ends terror support. India rejected a 15 May 2026 award by a Court of Arbitration it calls 'illegally constituted'. The treaty (World Bank-brokered) gives Pakistan about 80% of the Indus system's waters	✔
BRICS	**18th BRICS Summit, 12–13 Sept 2026, Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi**; India's 4th chairship (after 2012, 2016, 2021); theme 'Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability'. **Xi Jinping** visited India for the first time in nearly seven years. Indian government sources list 11 members, including Egypt, Ethiopia, Indonesia, Iran and the UAE. 10 partner countries joined in 2025 (Belarus, Bolivia, Cuba, Kazakhstan, Malaysia, Nigeria, Thailand, Uganda, Uzbekistan, Vietnam). India opted out of the BRICS Plus naval exercise 'Will for Peace 2026'. **China chairs BRICS in 2027**	✔
India–China	Gradual reset: Modi attended the SCO summit at Tianjin (31 Aug–1 Sept 2025); a senior Chinese official, Sun Haiyan, visited India in Jan 2026 and met Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri; border dispute and China–Pakistan ties still unresolved	✔
India–US	Trade friction in 2025 (tariffs up to 50%) then an **interim framework in Feb 2026** cutting US tariffs to 18%. The Quad leaders' summit that India was to host has been delayed	✔
Other 2025–26 diplomacy	India hosted the **AI Impact Summit** (Feb 2026). Modi visited Jordan, Ethiopia (first PM visit in 15 years) and Oman in Dec 2025. France invited Modi to the G7 at Évian (June 2026); French President Macron visited India in Feb 2026. Putin's annual-summit visit to Delhi in Dec 2025 ◆	✔
Your PYQ treaties	India–Australia ECTA in force 29 Dec 2022; US–India Climate and Clean Energy Agenda 2030 (Apr 2021); Haryana–Dubai MoU (Oct 2022); Kovind received Croatia's Order of King Dmitar Zvonimir (Mar 2019) ◆	

Trade deals (India–EU FTA, India–UK CETA, India–US framework) are detailed in the Finance part.

3. Summits and organisations, 2026–27

Event	Date and place	Notes	Chk
52nd G7 Summit	15–17 June 2026, Évian-les-Bains, France	French presidency; Modi was invited	✔
NATO Summit	7–8 July 2026, Ankara, Türkiye (Beştepe Complex)	Türkiye's second NATO summit after Istanbul 2004; Secretary-General Mark Rutte	✔
SCO Summit	31 Aug–1 Sept 2026, Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan	2025 was Tianjin, China; 2027 host is Islamabad ◆	✔
18th BRICS Summit	12–13 Sept 2026, New Delhi	See Section 2	✔
81st UN General Assembly	Opened 8 Sept 2026, New York	High-level week 21–23 Sept 2026	✔
IMF/World Bank Annual Meetings	12–18 Oct 2026, Bangkok, Thailand		✔
COP31	9–20 Nov 2026, Antalya, Türkiye	Türkiye holds the COP presidency; **Australia leads the negotiations** (it withdrew its host bid). Pre-COP was held in Fiji in Oct 2026	✔
APEC Leaders' Meeting	Nov 2026, Shenzhen, China		✔
21st G20 Summit	14–15 Dec 2026, Trump National Doral, Miami, USA	South Africa was not invited; the UK hosts in 2027	✔
Earlier: G20 2025	22–23 Nov 2025, Johannesburg	First G20 summit in Africa	✔

International days from your PYQs: International Year of Millets 2023 (FAO opened it in Rome), UHC Day (12 Dec; 2021 theme 'Leave No One's Health Behind'), International Day for Monuments and Sites (18 April).

4. Defence: exercises, budget and purchases

4A. Exercises (ask-by-name table)

Exercise	Partner / host	Service and focus	Latest edition	Chk
Yudh Abhyas	USA	Army; counter-terrorism, high-altitude	21st edition, 1–14 Sept 2025, Fort Wainwright, Alaska	✔
Dharma Guardian	Japan	Army; urban warfare, counter-terrorism	7th edition, 24 Feb–9 Mar 2026, Chaubattia, Uttarakhand	✔
Nomadic Elephant	Mongolia	Army; counter-insurgency, mountain	17th edition, June 2025, Ulaanbaatar	✔
Garuda Shakti	Indonesia	Special forces	10th edition, Dec 2025, Bakloh, Himachal Pradesh	✔
Khanjar	Kyrgyzstan	Special forces	4–17 Feb 2026, Missamari, Assam	✔
Shakti	France	Army (semi-desert)	India–France; held every alternate year	◆
SAMPRITI (PYQ)	Bangladesh	Army; counter-insurgency	SAMPRITI-IX in Meghalaya (Feb 2020 in your PYQ)	
DUSTLIK (PYQ)	Uzbekistan	Army	4th edition, Feb 2023, Uttarakhand (PYQ)	
Garuda (PYQ)	France	Air Force; Garuda-VII in Oct–Nov 2022 at Jodhpur		
Pitch Black (PYQ)	Australia (Darwin)	Air Force; biennial, 20 nations in 2024	2026 edition expected mid-2026 ◆	◆
Tarang Shakti	India hosts	Air Force; India's first multinational air exercise (2024)	Second edition planned 26 Sept–12 Oct 2026 ◆	◆
Malabar	USA, Japan, Australia	Navy; all four Quad nations	Started 1992 (India–US); Japan joined 2015, Australia 2020	◆
IND-INDO CORPAT (PYQ)	Indonesia	Navies; coordinated patrol		

4B. Budget, purchases and organisations

Item	Facts	Chk
Defence Budget 2026-27	**₹7,84,678 crore (about ₹7.85 lakh crore)**, up 15% from ₹6,81,210 crore; capital outlay ₹2.19 lakh crore (+21.84%); first Budget after Operation Sindoor	✔
114 Rafale (MRFA)	**Defence Acquisition Council, 12 Feb 2026**, chaired by Rajnath Singh: cleared **114 Rafale** jets from France under a government-to-government deal (about ₹3.25 lakh crore, the largest defence purchase) within a ₹3.6 lakh crore package that also included six P-8I aircraft. Macron visited India days later. Navy had ordered 26 Rafale-M earlier	✔
Other programmes	Tejas Mk1A: 97 jets contracted (deliveries from 2027-28) · AMCA (indigenous fifth-generation fighter; BEL–ADA MoU Feb 2023 is your PYQ) · Project 75(I): six submarines with Germany near signing (about $8 billion)	✔
Operation Sindoor	See Section 2. Armed forces chiefs now: CDS Gen. N. Raja Subramani, Army Gen. Dhiraj Seth, Navy Adm. Krishna Swaminathan (see Politics part)	✔
Your PYQ organisations	**ARDE** (DRDO's Armament Research and Development Establishment) developed Nipun anti-personnel mines · **Shekatkar Committee** (Lt Gen D. B. Shekatkar) on combat capability and defence expenditure · **Operation Sadbhawana** = Army outreach in J&K · **Operation Megh Chakra** = CBI drive against child sexual abuse material · Army–11 banks MoU for Agniveers (Oct 2022)	

5. Reports and indices

Report / index	India's latest position	Chk
Sustainable Development Report (SDG Index), UN SDSN	**94th of 167 (2026)**, score 68.3 – India's best ever; 99th in 2025 (its first top-100), 109th in 2024. Finland 1st, Sweden 2nd, Denmark 3rd. India has risen 18 places since 2015. One source gives 95th of 169, so use 94 unless the question says otherwise. Your PYQ: 121 of 163 in 2022	✔
Global Hunger Index 2025	**102nd of 123** ('serious')	✔
WEF Global Gender Gap Report 2025	**131 of 148**	✔
UNDP Human Development Index	130 of 193 (score 0.685, 'medium') – 2025 report using 2023 data	✔
World Happiness Report 2025	116 of 147	✔
ILO World Social Protection Report (your PYQ)	47% of the world population had at least one social protection benefit (2020-22 report)	
UNFPA State of World Population 2019 (your PYQ)	Smallest-population country listed: Vatican City	

Check the date: Global Gender Gap, Happiness and other annual reports may have a newer 2026 edition. Use the latest edition named in the question.

6. Practice MCQs (25)

Answers are on the last page. Each question uses facts marked ✔ above.

1. The 18th BRICS Summit (2026) was held at:
(A) Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi (B) Yashobhoomi, Delhi (C) Vigyan Bhawan (D) Gandhinagar

2. India chaired BRICS in 2026 for the ____ time:
(A) third (B) fourth (C) second (D) fifth

3. Who chairs BRICS in 2027?
(A) Brazil (B) Russia (C) China (D) South Africa

4. The 2026 SCO Summit was held in:
(A) Tianjin (B) Astana (C) Dushanbe (D) Bishkek

5. COP31 (Nov 2026) is hosted in:
(A) Antalya, Türkiye (B) Sharm el-Sheikh (C) Belém (D) Sydney

6. The 21st G20 Summit (Dec 2026) is in:
(A) Cape Town (B) Miami (C) Seoul (D) London

7. The 2026 NATO Summit was held in:
(A) The Hague (B) Vilnius (C) Ankara (D) Madrid

8. The 52nd G7 Summit (June 2026) was hosted by:
(A) Canada (B) Italy (C) Germany (D) France

9. Operation Sindoor was launched in:
(A) May 2025 (B) Feb 2019 (C) Sept 2016 (D) Aug 2025

10. The Pahalgam terror attack (22 Apr 2025) killed:
(A) 18 (B) 26 (C) 34 (D) 41

11. The Indus Waters Treaty (1960) is currently:
(A) Terminated (B) Renegotiated (C) In abeyance (D) Extended

12. The Indus Waters Treaty was brokered by:
(A) United Nations (B) IMF (C) WTO (D) World Bank

13. India's Defence Budget for 2026-27 is about:
(A) ₹7.85 lakh crore (B) ₹6.81 lakh crore (C) ₹9 lakh crore (D) ₹5.9 lakh crore

14. How many Rafale jets did the DAC clear on 12 Feb 2026?
(A) 36 (B) 114 (C) 26 (D) 57

15. Dharma Guardian is a joint army exercise with:
(A) Australia (B) France (C) Japan (D) Russia

16. The 21st Yudh Abhyas (Sept 2025) was held at:
(A) Rajasthan (B) Uttarakhand (C) Odisha (D) Fort Wainwright, Alaska

17. Nomadic Elephant is an India exercise with:
(A) Mongolia (B) Kazakhstan (C) Nepal (D) Uzbekistan

18. Garuda Shakti is an India exercise with:
(A) Thailand (B) Indonesia (C) Malaysia (D) Singapore

19. SAMPRITI is an India joint exercise with:
(A) Sri Lanka (B) Nepal (C) Bangladesh (D) Bhutan

20. Exercise Pitch Black is hosted by:
(A) USA (B) UK (C) Japan (D) Australia

21. India's rank in the SDG Index 2026:
(A) 94th (B) 99th (C) 109th (D) 121st

22. India's rank in the Global Hunger Index 2025:
(A) 94 (B) 102 (C) 111 (D) 127

23. The new Supreme Leader of Iran after Feb 2026:
(A) Hassan Rouhani (B) Ali Larijani (C) Mojtaba Khamenei (D) Masoud Pezeshkian

24. Which strait became the centre of the 2026 Gulf crisis?
(A) Strait of Malacca (B) Bab-el-Mandeb (C) Bosphorus (D) Strait of Hormuz

25. The 2026 US midterm elections are on:
(A) 3 Nov 2026 (B) 5 Nov 2026 (C) 1 Dec 2026 (D) 14 Dec 2026

Answer key

1-A **2**-B **3**-C **4**-D **5**-A **6**-B **7**-C **8**-D **9**-A **10**-B **11**-C **12**-D **13**-A **14**-B **15**-C **16**-D **17**-A **18**-B **19**-C **20**-D **21**-A **22**-B **23**-C **24**-D **25**-A

Before you rely on this: Section 1 is a snapshot, so re-check the Iran war and Russia–Ukraine talks the week of your exam. Also check the ◆ items (Pitch Black 2026 and Tarang Shakti 2026 dates, the 2027 SCO host, Putin's Dec 2025 visit) and the Quad summit status. Reply **'next'** for the next part (Science, Space, Technology and Environment).